

From a Stage Performer to a Scriptwriter

*Vocabulary & Grammar Handout
Intermediate Level*

THE TEXT (Corrected Version)

Note: Only grammar and spelling errors have been corrected. Corrections are shown in bold.

"Lately, I've been so troubled that I **haven't been able to** fall asleep every night." Ema complained about the pressures of her career with blushed cheeks. "It's really a huge hassle that **is making** me overwhelmed..... I'd love to know your opinion on this matter." She lied on the sofa lazily, **her** eyes filled with **helplessness and sadness**..... I **was** well aware of the **contradiction**; she definitely didn't want to discuss this problem with me. **Therefore**, I decided to **keep** silence rather than **chatter**, **as** letting her complain might be more effective in calming her **emotions**.

Ema is one of my **relatives**, and also a **twenty-year-old** office worker. She **quit** a highly paid **job** last week, and has been hesitating about whether **to keep** her stable job, or venture into a challenging realm, and give up the stability.....

This semester at school, each **sixth-grade** class **has** to complete a **10-minute** drama together, showcasing the results of six **years** of learning— Enthusiasm, Courage, **Responsibility, Cooperation**. From **composing** a draft, rehearsing, **to recording** a performance, the teachers will vote for the most marvelous performance in the category, and **reward the winner with a present**. Everyone is ready to overcome the final task, including meIncluding me?

Because of my resonant voice, I was assigned to "A" group (Performance group) and **made responsible for** the performance. Although I tend to complete the draft and edit the videos, I agreed anyway, and my agreement **came** from a desire to try.

However, things didn't go as I expected. Today is the "fifth" day of the competition; **though** my performances are not too terrible, I'm getting more and more tired and overwhelmed **every day**. No one knows that I'm not good at acting; I even get a little nervous when I step on the stage.

Finally, I explained this problem carefully to the leader of my class, and got the **agreement to enter** the editing group. I'm starting to think my previous behavior was stupid. The journey is **always** arduous; the only **things that can be changed are** the path you will embark on, your courage to overcome the hurdles, the approach, and what you see as your own life.....

THE TEXT (Improved Version)

Note: This version has been rewritten for clarity, flow, and vivid expression while preserving the writer's original meaning and voice.

"Lately, I've been so troubled that I can't fall asleep at night." Ema complained about the pressures of her career, her cheeks flushed with frustration. "It's such a huge hassle, and it's really overwhelming me..... I'd love to know your opinion on this matter." She sprawled on the sofa lazily, her eyes brimming with helplessness and sadness.

I was well aware of the contradiction in her words. Deep down, she didn't really want to discuss this problem with me. Therefore, I decided to keep silent rather than chatter away; letting her pour out her feelings would be far more effective in soothing her emotions.

Ema is one of my relatives, a twenty-year-old office worker. Just last week, she landed a highly paid position, yet she has been wavering ever since — should she cling to the stability of her steady job, or venture into a more challenging realm and risk everything she has built?

This semester at school, each sixth-grade class has to collaborate on a ten-minute drama to showcase six years of learning. Enthusiasm, courage, responsibility, and cooperation — all are put to the test. From composing a draft and rehearsing, to recording the final performance, the teachers will vote for the most marvelous piece in each category, and the first-place winner will be rewarded with a prize. Everyone is ready to conquer this final task, including me..... Including me?

Because of my resonant voice, I was assigned to Group A, the performance group, and was made responsible for acting on stage. Although I usually prefer to draft scripts and edit videos behind the scenes, I agreed anyway — my agreement sprang from a genuine desire to try something new.

However, things didn't unfold as I had expected. Today marks the "fifth" day of the competition. Although my performances are not too terrible, I grow more exhausted and overwhelmed with each passing day. No one suspects that I'm not actually good at acting; I even feel a flutter of nerves whenever I step onto the stage.

Finally, I explained my struggles carefully to the leader of my class, and was granted permission to join the editing group. I'm beginning to realize my previous decision was foolish. The journey itself will always be arduous; the only things within our power to change are the path we embark on, the courage we summon to overcome each hurdle, the approach we take, and the way we see our own life.....

PART A: VOCABULARY (12 Words)

Study the following vocabulary words from the text. Pay attention to how each word is used in context.

#	Word	Definition	Example from Text
1	flushed (adj.)	red in the face, often from emotion, heat, or exertion	<i>"Her cheeks flushed with frustration."</i>
2	sprawl (v.)	to sit or lie with one's arms and legs spread out in a relaxed or careless way	<i>"She sprawled on the sofa lazily."</i>
3	brim (v.)	to be full of a particular feeling or quality, almost to the point of overflowing	<i>"Her eyes brimming with helplessness and sadness."</i>
4	contradiction (n.)	a situation in which two ideas or statements are opposed to each other	<i>"I was well aware of the contradiction in her words."</i>
5	soothe (v.)	to gently calm a person, or to relieve pain or unpleasant feelings	<i>"Far more effective in soothing her emotions."</i>
6	waver (v.)	to be undecided between two choices; to hesitate	<i>"She has been wavering ever since."</i>
7	cling (v.)	to hold on tightly to something; to refuse to let go	<i>"Should she cling to the stability of her steady job?"</i>
8	venture (v.)	to do something risky or bold; to dare to go somewhere new	<i>"Venture into a more challenging realm."</i>
9	collaborate (v.)	to work together with others on a shared task or project	<i>"Each sixth-grade class has to collaborate on a ten-minute drama."</i>
10	conquer (v.)	to successfully overcome a problem or difficulty	<i>"Everyone is ready to conquer this final task."</i>
11	resonant (adj.)	(of a voice or sound) deep, full, and clear, lasting a long time	<i>"Because of my resonant voice."</i>
12	arduous (adj.)	involving a lot of effort and difficulty; very hard	<i>"The journey itself will always be arduous."</i>

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best word to complete each sentence.

1. The long hike up the mountain was _____, but the view at the top made it worth every step.

- a) resonant
- b) arduous
- c) flushed
- d) lush

2. After running for thirty minutes, his face was bright red and _____.

- a) sprawled
- b) brimming
- c) flushed
- d) soothed

3. The singer's _____ voice filled the entire concert hall.

- a) arduous
- b) flushed
- c) resonant
- d) wavering

4. Her eyes were _____ with tears as she watched the emotional scene.

- a) brimming
- b) clinging
- c) venturing
- d) conquering

5. Two scientists decided to _____ on the research paper to combine their expertise.

- a) waver
- b) sprawl
- c) collaborate
- d) cling

6. The child _____ to his mother's hand as they crossed the busy street.

- a) conquered
- b) soothed
- c) brimmed
- d) clung

7. After years of hard work, she finally _____ her fear of public speaking.

- a) wavered
- b) conquered
- c) sprawled
- d) flushed

8. The young entrepreneur decided to _____ into a brand-new market.

- a) cling
- b) brim
- c) venture
- d) soothe

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

Complete each sentence with the correct word from the box. You may need to change the form of the word.

soothe waver contradiction sprawl collaborate arduous

1. The gentle music helped to _____ the crying baby.
2. She kept _____ between accepting the job offer and staying at her current company.
3. There is a clear _____ between what he says and what he actually does.
4. The dog _____ across the carpet, enjoying the warm sunlight.
5. The two schools _____ on a joint science project.
6. Climbing Mount Everest is an _____ task that requires months of preparation.

PART B: GRAMMAR (4 Patterns)

Study the following grammar structures from the text.

Pattern 1: Participial phrase as modifier (present participle)

Form: Main clause, + -ing phrase (describing the subject or situation)

Use: To add descriptive detail about the subject or a related element in a concise, flowing way — like a "second picture" attached to the main sentence.

Example from text: *"She sprawled on the sofa lazily, her eyes brimming with helplessness and sadness."*

More examples:

- He walked into the room, humming a soft tune.
- The children ran through the field, their laughter echoing across the hills.
- She sat by the window, a warm cup of tea resting in her hands.

Pattern 2: "rather than" + bare infinitive / gerund

Form: Subject + verb + A + rather than + B

Use: To express a preference for one action or choice over another.

Example from text: *"I decided to keep silent rather than chatter away."*

More examples:

- She chose to walk rather than take the bus.
- He prefers reading books rather than watching television.
- We should save our money rather than spend it on unnecessary things.

Pattern 3: "the only + noun + (that) + clause + is/are..."

Form: The only + noun + (that) + subject + can / will + verb + is / are + complement

Use: To emphasize that there is just one specific thing, and then identify exactly what it is.

Example from text: *"The only things within our power to change are the path we embark on, the courage we summon..."*

More examples:

- The only thing that matters is your effort.
- The only person who can solve this problem is you.
- The only things I need are time and patience.

Pattern 4: "with each + noun"

Form: Subject + verb..., with each + (passing) + noun

Use: To show that something changes gradually as more of something happens or passes (often time).

Example from text: *"I grow more exhausted and overwhelmed with each passing day."*

More examples:

- She felt more confident with each presentation.
- The sky grew darker with each passing minute.
- His English improved with each lesson.

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer to complete each sentence.

1. The old man sat on the bench, _____ at the children playing in the park.

- a) smiles
- b) smiled
- c) smiling
- d) to smile

2. She decided to stay home _____ go to the party.

- a) rather than
- b) instead
- c) besides
- d) in spite of

3. The only thing _____ matters is that you did your best.

- a) what
- b) that
- c) who
- d) where

4. His handwriting became neater _____ page he wrote.

- a) by each
- b) on each
- c) with each
- d) from each

5. They walked along the beach, _____ seashells as they went.

- a) collect
- b) collecting
- c) collected
- d) to collect

6. The only people _____ can help us now are the engineers.

- a) who
- b) which
- c) where
- d) what

7. He chose to tell the truth _____ hide his mistake.

- a) rather than
- b) more than
- c) other than
- d) less than

8. The students grew more tired _____ hour of the long test.

- a) with every
- b) in every
- c) at every
- d) by every

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation

Rewrite each sentence using the grammar pattern in brackets.

1. (Participial phrase) Combine: "She stood at the window. She watched the snow fall gently."

(Start: *She stood at the window, _____*)

2. (Participial phrase) Combine: "The baby slept in the crib. Her tiny hands were curled into fists."

(Start: *The baby slept in the crib, _____*)

3. (rather than) Combine: "I will take a taxi. I will not walk in the rain."

(Use: *rather than*)

4. (rather than) Combine: "He prefers to cook dinner at home. He does not like to eat at restaurants."

(Use: *rather than*)

5. (the only + noun) Rewrite so that this becomes a "the only" sentence: "You are the person who truly understands me."

(Start: The only person _____)

6. (the only + noun) Rewrite: "Patience is the thing we need most right now."

(Start: The only thing _____)

7. (with each + noun) Rewrite: "Every year that passes, she becomes wiser."

(Use: with each)

8. (with each + noun) Rewrite: "Every step he took, the mountain looked closer."

(Use: with each)

ANSWER KEY

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. b) arduous 2. c) flushed 3. c) resonant 4. a) brimming 5. c) collaborate 6. d) clung 7. b) conquered 8. c) venture

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

1. soothe 2. wavering 3. contradiction 4. sprawled 5. collaborated 6. arduous

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. c) smiling 2. a) rather than 3. b) that 4. c) with each 5. b) collecting 6. a) who
7. a) rather than 8. a) with every

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation (Sample Answers)

1. She stood at the window, watching the snow fall gently.
2. The baby slept in the crib, her tiny hands curled into fists.
3. I will take a taxi rather than walk in the rain.
4. He prefers to cook dinner at home rather than eat at restaurants.
5. The only person who truly understands me is you.
6. The only thing we need most right now is patience.
7. She becomes wiser with each passing year.
8. The mountain looked closer with each step he took.